rapidly one after the other, splashing water all around. By this manoeuvre, we hoped to impress the girls, but I don't think they were either impressed or amused.

In the educational system of those days, one had to choose streams in the 9th Standard itself and follow that stream till the board exams in the 11th. To help us make up our minds, the school engaged an agency to administer us an aptitude test. The questions were entirely picture-based. Out of a set of three pictures depicting different activities, we had to choose the one we liked best. One set could be a person either in a laboratory or catching butterflies or reading a book. There were a number of such sets showing different combinations of activities. Based on your answer, the results would show your aptitude for science or the arts, etc. My results showed an overwhelming preference for outdoor activities. I don't know about the others, but I feel that in my case, it was a fair assessment, considering that I can't sing or dance, or paint or play any musical instrument, though I appreciate all these art forms.

Irrespective of where we were, it was understood that the summer holidays would be spent in Pune. All of my mother's siblings also tried their best to come. Ai-Dada had five children and thirteen grandchildren. At least half a dozen of us cousins would be there in the Karve Road house during the summer. The house had only three biggish rooms. There was only one bathroom and a separate toilet, so the day was one endless parade to and from these places for our ablutions, where we would go in turn, taking a 'time-out' from whichever game we were playing. There were five of us who were born in the 1960s—Ravindra, myself, Kaushik, Aloke and Veena, and we used to consider ourselves special. From time to time, someone would buy a book, usually an Enid Blyton, which we would read in turn. At night, mattresses would be laid out on

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